

Consent Letter

The purpose of this research is to better understand the types of psychosocial and socioeconomic circumstances that people discuss when seeking information, advice, or support from large language models (LLMs). We are conducting this study to understand whether LLMs can be used to classify the context of help-seeking conversations in a manner similar to human annotators with relevant domain expertise.

As part of this study, you will be asked to review de-identified user messages from a publicly available dataset of human–LLM conversations. Using a provided annotation guide, you will identify and categorize the types of life circumstances or problems described in each message. Examples may include educational, occupational, economic, housing, interpersonal, social, legal, health-related, or other psychosocial circumstances. You may also provide optional notes explaining your reasoning for difficult or ambiguous cases.

Annotation work will be organized into batches, with each batch consisting of approximately 7–8 conversations and expected to take about 15 minutes to complete. Participants may complete up to 15 annotation batches. The total time required to complete all assigned annotation batches is expected to be approximately 3–4 hours. All annotation tasks may be completed remotely and asynchronously.

Participants will receive compensation in the form of Amazon gift cards for completing annotation batches. Participants will receive \$5 for each completed annotation batch submitted to the research team. A batch is considered complete when all conversations in the assigned batch have been annotated and the batch has been successfully submitted through the study platform. Compensation is based solely on the completion and submission of annotation batches and is not contingent on the content of participants' responses, the quality of their annotations, or any evaluation of their performance. Participants will receive compensation only for annotation batches that are fully completed and submitted. Partial completion of a batch will not be compensated. Participants who do not complete and submit a batch will not receive compensation for that batch.

Participants may complete up to 15 annotation batches and may receive up to \$75 in total compensation. Amazon gift cards will be distributed after the research team has confirmed receipt of completed annotation batches.

The potential risks to participants are minimal. Some messages may contain sensitive or potentially distressing content, including discussions of relationship difficulties, abuse, trauma, mental health concerns, self-harm, suicide, grief, financial hardship, or other difficult life circumstances. Participation is voluntary, and you may discontinue participation at any time without penalty. If you experience distress and would like support, resources are available through SafeUT (<https://safeut.org/>).

Results may be reported in publications or presentations, but no identifying information about participants will be disclosed.

If you have any questions, complaints, or concerns about this research, please contact:

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Contact the Institutional Review Board (IRB) if you have questions about your rights as a research participant. You may also contact the IRB if you have questions, complaints, or concerns that you do not feel comfortable discussing with the investigators. The University of Utah IRB may be reached by e-mail at irb@hsc.utah.edu.

Participation in this study is voluntary. You may choose to withdraw from the study at any time without penalty.

By proceeding with the annotation task, you are indicating your consent to participate in this research study.

Thank you for your participation.